

Stage 6 — Geographic, Category & Organizational Expansion

Timing: Year 2 | Objective: Expand only after the initial marketplace model demonstrates repeatability

Primary task

Expand the marketplace without destroying liquidity, customer trust or unit economics.

Geographic expansion

- Choose expansion locations based on demand, supply availability, logistics economics and operational readiness.
- Launch one meaningful geography at a time where possible.
- Re-test assumptions because customer behavior and logistics can vary by location.

Category expansion

- Add categories where there is customer demand and reliable vendor supply.
- Avoid adding categories merely to make the catalog look larger.
- Measure category-level conversion, repeat behavior, margins, returns and fulfillment performance.

Organization

- Formalize leadership ownership across technology, operations, growth and finance.
- Introduce management reporting and planning cycles.
- Document hiring criteria based on business bottlenecks rather than prestige or headcount targets.

Capital strategy

- Determine whether the company should prioritize profitability, bootstrapped growth or external capital.
- If fundraising is pursued, build the narrative around validated traction, market evidence, unit economics, operational capability and a clear use of funds.
- Maintain financial controls regardless of funding strategy.

Lean Startup application

- Expansion should be treated as a new set of hypotheses, not simply a copy-and-paste of the first market.
- Preserve experimentation and validated learning while increasing organizational scale.
- Use evidence to decide which aspects of the original model are transferable and which need adaptation.

Exit criteria

- The original market has a stable operating model.
- Expansion economics and logistics are understood.
- Leadership capacity exists for multiple markets or major categories.
- The company has a clear capital and profitability strategy.

Founder question: Which parts of Shopiva's current model have been proven to be repeatable, and which parts are still location- or founder-dependent?

Framework reference: Eric Ries, *The Lean Startup* (Crown Business, 2011). This roadmap applies Lean Startup concepts such as validated learning, the Build–Measure–Learn loop, minimum viable product (MVP), innovation accounting, and pivot/persevere decisions. It does not reproduce the book's text.